



Norwegian Aura: Hosted Solo Group

October 14 – 21, 2028 · A Maulsby Travel Co. hosted group

Ship: Norwegian Aura · **Sailing from:** Miami (NCL's PortMiami terminal) · **Cabin:** _____

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#): the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers the ship, each port, packing, budget, emergency contacts and the group.

Day by day

Times are from cruise booking sites (iCruise and CruiseWeb) for this sailing, read October 2026. **Check them in the NCL app before you sail.** All-aboard is one hour before departure (NCL's rule).

#	Date	Port	In port	All aboard	Worth knowing
1	Sat Oct 14	Miami: boarding	ship leaves 4:00 PM	per your boarding time	Fly in Friday. Sailaway meetup: watch the group chat.
2	Sun Oct 15	At sea	—	—	Ocean Heights early, Ocean Boulevard for coffee, book specialty dinners.
3	Mon Oct 16	Puerto Plata, Dominican Republic	7:00 AM – 3:00 PM	2:00 PM	Pier not published for Aura (likely Taino Bay, by the old town). Cable car closed for rebuild; check before planning on it. Waterfalls: take NCL's tour.
4	Tue Oct 17	St. Thomas, USVI	10:00 AM – 6:00 PM	5:00 PM	Magens Bay (\$7 entry). St. John: hourly ferry from Red Hook, \$8.15 each way. They drive on the left.
5	Wed Oct 18	Tortola, BVI	7:00 AM – 2:00 PM	1:00 PM	The short day. Cane Garden Bay by taxi, or Road Town on foot. For The Baths, use NCL's tour.
6	Thu Oct 19	At sea	—	—	Spa, a long lunch, settle your account in the app.
7	Fri Oct 20	Great Stirrup Cay, Bahamas	10:00 AM – 6:00 PM	5:00 PM	Walk off at the pier. Beaches, food and pool included; Great Tides Waterpark extra.
8	Sat Oct 21	Miami: home	arrive 7:00 AM	—	Book a flight after midday.

Book through Mulsby Travel Co. to be in the group: [Tina Mulsby](#), tina@maulsbytravel.com, 910-528-5077. **Flyer fares:** Solo Studio \$1,599 · Ocean View \$2,279 · Balcony \$2,669 (can change until you book).

NCL's service charge: \$20 per person per day, \$25 in The Haven and suites (2026 rate). **Ask Tina** what your fare includes: drinks, Wi-Fi, specialty dining.

Passport: needed for this cruise. For the Dominican Republic, keep it valid **through at least April 2029**.

October weather, in one line: Hot everywhere: highs 82 to 87°F, warm nights, and rain on about half the days (Miami two days in three). Averages for October 14 to 21, 2020 to 2024, not a forecast. It's still hurricane season; travel insurance is worth having.

Getting to the ship and getting home

Friday arrival, Saturday boarding

Friday, October 13: fly in. The ship leaves at 4:00 PM, and a same-day flight leaves no margin.

Saturday, October 14: boarding.

- **Terminal:** NCL's PortMiami terminal, 1015 N. America Way. NCL says to enter **1761 N. Cruise Blvd.** in your GPS and park in **Garage B**. Your boarding documents name the terminal; check them.
- **Online check-in** in the NCL app before you leave home.
- **Carry-on:** passport, medications, swimsuit, change of clothes, charger.

Saturday, October 21: home

- The ship is due in at 7:00 AM. NCL tells you the night before how bags and walk-off work.
- Keep your passport, medications and a change of clothes with you.

Areas of interest during the cruise

On the ship (as NCL has announced it)

- **Ocean Heights**, Decks 18 to 21: Eclipse Racers, Aura Free Fall, The Wave, The Drop (Deck 18 to Deck 8), ropes course, climbing wall, mini golf. Check the app for any fees.
- **Ocean Boulevard**, Deck 8: the outdoor walkway with hot tubs and a bar.
- **Studio Lounge**: for Solo Studio guests only. Where solo cruisers find each other.
- **Indulge Food Hall**: nine counters, easy for eating alone.
- **Shows**: *Whitney: A Celebration of Whitney Houston* and others. LunaTique is adults-only and costs extra.

Specialty dining

New on Aura: **Tamara**, NCL's first Indian restaurant (Deck 8). Also [Cagney's](#), [Le Bistro](#), [Sukhothai](#), [Palomar](#), [Onda by Scarpetta](#), [Hasuki](#) and [Nama](#). Book when NCL opens reservations.

Port-day picks (one each)

- **Puerto Plata**: the old town and Fortaleza San Felipe, if you dock at Taino Bay. Or NCL's Damajagua Waterfalls tour (from \$119.99 in 2026; age 8 and up; closed-toe shoes).
- **St. Thomas**: Magens Bay. Taxis charge per person (\$15 one person, \$12 each for two or more, Havensight to Magens Bay, on a 2024 rate card).
- **Tortola**: Cane Garden Bay (\$10 to \$16 per person by taxi each way, per a 2026 travel guide). Back by 1:00 PM.
- **Great Stirrup Cay**: a beach, lunch and the pool, all included.

The group

The flyer promises a dedicated host, daily group dining, group shore excursion options, meetups and a private group chat. Nothing is required. Go to one dinner and see.

The one-page emergency handoff card is a separate document. The full Voyage Pack covers everything here in more depth. Soli Deo Gloria.